



Indian boxing great Mary Kom receives the coveted Ace of Aces award from Sportstar Aces jury member M. M. Somaya and Diptakirti Chaudhuri, CMO, Casagrand, in recognition of an extraordinary legacy. Right: Olympic medallist wrestler Sakshi Malik is presented the Ace of Aces award by former India women's cricket team captain Jhulan Goswami and Saumitra Srivastava, Director-Marketing, IOCL, honouring her enduring contribution to Indian sport. VIJAY SONEJI

Ace of Aces

Indian sporting icons Mary Kom and Sakshi Malik were honoured with the Ace of Aces award at the Sportstar Aces Awards 2026 in Mumbai.

Few athletes in the country have embodied resilience and longevity quite like Mary. Across two decades, the boxer from Manipur built one of the most remarkable careers in the history of the sport, becoming the first woman to win six world titles at the AIBA Women's World Boxing Championships.

Her decorated career includes a bronze medal at the 2012 Summer Olympics, five Asian Championship titles and a historic gold at the 2014 Asian Games, the first by an Indian woman boxer.

Mary received the award from M. M. Somaya, Sportstar Aces Awards jury member, and Diptakirti Chaudhuri (Chief Marketing Officer,

CasaGrand). Accepting the honour, she reflected on the final chapter of her competitive career and the challenges that followed.

"I would like to thank the jury members and Sportstar for giving me this award. It has been almost three years since I last competed in any competition because of the age

limit in women's boxing. I wanted to continue for as long as I could, but unfortunately, the age restriction meant I could not compete during this period," Mary said after receiving her award.

"Having said that, being a mother is a bigger challenge than being a boxer. But with patience and willpower, you can accomplish anything. We need your support, not just for me but for everyone who is contributing to sports in our country."

Another trailblazer

If Mary's story is one of sustained excellence, Sakshi's is etched in the memory of Indian sport for one unforgettable night in Rio.

At the 2016 Summer Olympics, Sakshi became the first Indian woman wrestler to win an Olympic medal, claiming bronze in women's freestyle wrestling. Her campaign

